

2030, scaling to 1.35 million GT by 2047, against India's national targets of 0.5 and 4.0 million GT, respectively. This translates into real investment of over ₹6,600 crore by 2030, growing to over ₹18,000 crore by 2047. It has the employment potential of over 40,000 by 2030, rising to over 1,40,000 by 2047.

The core of this vision is our Marine Shipyard Clusters, bringing shipbuilding, ship repair and ship recycling units together with ancillary industries, skilling facilities and shipyard support facilities in a single cluster-based approach. This reduces logistics costs, shares common infrastructure, and cuts project execution cycles significantly.

We have backed this with real financial incentives, not just intent. Developers get a capital subsidy of 15% of project cost. The policy also offers incentives for skill development and setting up of ship building, repair and recycling facilities.

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“Our aim is that Maharashtra must contribute at least one-third of India's entire shipbuilding, repair and recycling output”

Q: With the Navi Mumbai airport now operational, how are things progressing on the broader development of the Third Mumbai, which is envisaged to transform the Mumbai Metropolitan region?

A: The government has formally notified 124 villages across 323 sq. km with MMRDA (Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority) appointed as the New Town Development Authority. A participatory land acquisition model has also been introduced, giving local communities a genuine stake in this development.

The Raigad Pen growth hub will be the first city developed under Third Mumbai, envisioned as a business district on the lines of BKC. It is located 15 to 20 kms from Navi Mumbai International Airport. Built on a plug-and-play model, it will allow investors to begin operations immediately, and will host global capability centres, fintech hubs,

and a walk-to-work urban design. CIDCO (City and Industrial Development Corp) is currently finalising the master plan for the Aerocity, which will bring commercial, retail and logistics development around Navi Mumbai International Airport as part of the broader Third Mumbai ecosystem.

Edu City will host over 10 global universities and serve over one lakh students, positioning Maharashtra as a global education hub and help retain student talent. Medi City, spread over approximately 250 acres, will attract \$1.2 billion in investment and create over 10,000 jobs, strengthening healthcare services, medical research, and medical tourism.

Q: You spoke of data centres and GCCs. AI is gaining traction. Over time, what kind of opportunities will the state offer in these new sectors?

A: As Maharashtra already hosts over 700 GCCs, nearly 24% of India's total. We are now extending this into Tier-II and Tier-III cities such as Nashik, Nagpur and Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, to build new GCC growth corridors beyond Mumbai and Pune.

The Maharashtra GCC Policy 2025 targets 400 new GCCs and nearly four lakh high-skilled jobs, backed by fiscal and non-fiscal incentives. The state is developing dedicated GCC Parks, envisioned as self-sustaining business districts, alongside world-class business districts, combining university partnerships, GCC-focused skilling programmes, internships and industry-led curriculum development to build local talent pipelines.

This momentum is already visible on the ground. Accenture has leased around 6 lakh sq. ft. of office space in Pune, Kimberly-Clark India has operationalised its GCC in Pune, Nielsen has operationalised its GCC in Mumbai, and Brookfield has announced plans to invest up to \$1 billion in developing Asia's largest GCC hub in Powai.

The Maharashtra Global MedTech Zone is being developed as a world-class hub for medical device manufacturing and innovation, with the policy encouraging GCCs in medical technology and digital health to co-locate within this zone. Similarly, the Innovation City is envisioned as a next-generation cluster for deep-tech start-ups, with the policy promoting GCCs in frontier sectors such as AI, blockchain and robotics within this ecosystem. **BT**

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